

Skimming, Scanning & Fast Retrieval — Part 1

Name: _____

Date: _____

Time: 60 min

1 · COPY THIS DOWN — NOTES, STRUCTURES & TECHNIQUE

DEFINITIONS

Skimming = reading fast for the general gist (used first, to know what each paragraph is about). **Scanning** = hunting for one specific fact/name/number once you know roughly where it is.

THE TECHNIQUE — 4 STEPS FOR ANY RETRIEVAL QUESTION

1. Read the question first and underline the **keyword** (a name, number, place, or unusual word)
2. Skim paragraph topics once (first line of each paragraph usually tells you its subject)
3. Scan only the relevant paragraph for the keyword or a **synonym** of it
4. Re-read the full sentence around the match before answering — never answer from one isolated word

THE #1 TRAP — PARAPHRASE SWAP

Exam questions rarely use the exact words from the passage. If the question says "annoyed," the passage might say "irritated," "exasperated," or "through gritted teeth." Always scan for **meaning**, not exact spelling.

SENTENCE FRAME TO COPY

"The text states that ____, which shows/tells us ____."

2 · PRACTICE — 4 PASSAGES, 20 QUESTIONS

EXTRACT A — SCHOOL NOTICE

All Year 6 pupils must hand in their permission slips for the science museum trip by Thursday 14th. Slips handed in after this date will not guarantee a place, as the coach only holds 52 seats. A £4 contribution towards the coach fare should be given directly to Mrs. Whitlock, not left at the office.

1. By what day must permission slips be handed in?

2. Who should the £4 be given to?

3. What is the maximum number of seats on the coach?

4. What happens if a slip is handed in after the deadline?

5. Find a word in the notice that means roughly the same as "assure."

EXTRACT B — DIARY ENTRY

Saturday. Woke up furious because Ravi had eaten the last of the cereal again, but by the time we got to the allotment I'd completely forgotten about it — the tomatoes were finally ripe, deep red and warm from the sun, and Dad let me pick the first one myself.

6. What had Ravi done that morning?

7. What does the writer find at the allotment?

8. Find the word that shows how the tomatoes felt to touch.

9. Who let the writer pick the first tomato?

10. Find a word meaning "extremely angry."

EXTRACT C — INFORMATION LEAFLET

The Peregrine falcon is the fastest animal on Earth, capable of reaching speeds over 240 mph during its hunting dive, known as a stoop. Unlike many birds of prey, peregrines rarely build their own nests, instead reusing cliff ledges or, increasingly, tall city buildings.

11. What is the name given to the peregrine's hunting dive?

12. What speed can a peregrine reach during a stoop?

13. Where do peregrines increasingly nest, according to the leaflet?

14. Find a synonym in the text for "using again."

15. Is the peregrine described as building elaborate nests? Quote the evidence.

EXTRACT D — RECIPE INTRODUCTION

This traybake takes just 10 minutes to prepare but needs a full 35 minutes in the oven, so start it before your guests arrive. Do not open the oven door in the first 20 minutes, or the sponge may sink in the middle.

16. How long does the traybake take to prepare?

17. How long must it stay in the oven?

18. What might happen if the oven door is opened too early?

19. For how many minutes must the oven door stay shut?

20. Find the word that describes what could happen to the sponge.

Apply this every time: Always read the question before the passage on retrieval tasks, underline the keyword, then scan — don't read the whole passage top to bottom hunting blindly.

MARKING NOTES (FOR THE TUTOR)

1. Thursday 14th

2. Mrs. Whitlock

- | | |
|------------------------|---|
| 3. 52 | 12. over 240 mph |
| 4. No guaranteed place | 13. tall city buildings |
| 5. "guarantee" | 14. "reusing" |
| 6. ate the cereal | 15. No — "rarely build their own nests" |
| 7. ripe tomatoes | 16. 10 minutes |
| 8. "warm" | 17. 35 minutes |
| 9. Dad | 18. sponge may sink |
| 10. "furious" | 19. 20 minutes |
| 11. "stoop" | 20. "sink" |